MARKET DIAGNOSTIC

The TrustMRR Reality Check

Ten data points, three themes, one conclusion: why 1,000 listed “startups” are really a small set of real businesses inside a much larger pool of pre-revenue projects

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Source: TrustMRR, 1,000-row dataset, frozen 30 July 2026 | August 2026

TrustMRR is not a broad base of investable micro-SaaS businesses — it is a thin layer of real companies sitting on top of a large pool of pre-revenue projects.

This briefing walks through the ten data points behind that conclusion, organized into three themes.

THEME 1 · MARKET STRUCTURE

82%

of all tracked MRR sits with the top 10% of listings a power-law market, not a broad ecosystem

THEME 2 · WHAT SEPARATES WINNERS

4

observable signals such as B2B focus, domain authority, payment stack, and audience quality - reliably separate real businesses from the rest

THEME 3 · CAPITAL ALLOCATION

5.6x

higher MRR for on-sale listings vs. the average yet asking prices are priced inconsistently and shouldn't be trusted at face value

HIGH LEVEL APPROACH FLOW

One dataset, one funnel, one conclusion

1,000 listings are filtered down, chapter by chapter, to the handful that are actually real businesses — that filtering process is the entire argument of this deck.

1,000
listings on TrustMRR

The full population

01 Market structure
INSIGHTS COVERED
1 2 3

Power law + pre-revenue reality

02 What separates winners
INSIGHTS COVERED
4 5 6 7

The four-signal quality filter

03 Capital allocation
INSIGHTS COVERED
8 9 10

Where and how to apply it

CONCLUSION: TrustMRR is not a broad, investable ecosystem. It is a small set of real businesses, identifiable by four signals, worth finding inside a much larger pool of pre-revenue projects.

The argument in brief

Ten insights across three themes ladder up to one conclusion. This is the map — refer back to it as you move through the detail.

01

Market structure

1. Value is a power law — top 10% hold 82%
2. ~1 in 5 listings earn $0 in revenue
3. The largest category (AI) monetizes worst

02

What separates the winners

4. B2B monetizes 5.7x better than B2C
5. Domain authority is the strongest signal
6. Follower count is a vanity metric
7. Payment stack signals real maturity

03

Capital allocation implications

8. Geography is a proxy for pricing power
9. Asking-price multiples are inconsistent
10. Growth compounds for the largest players

THEREFORE: *The platform holds real value, but it is concentrated and hard to see through vanity metrics which is exactly what the next 13 slides prove, insight by insight.*

01

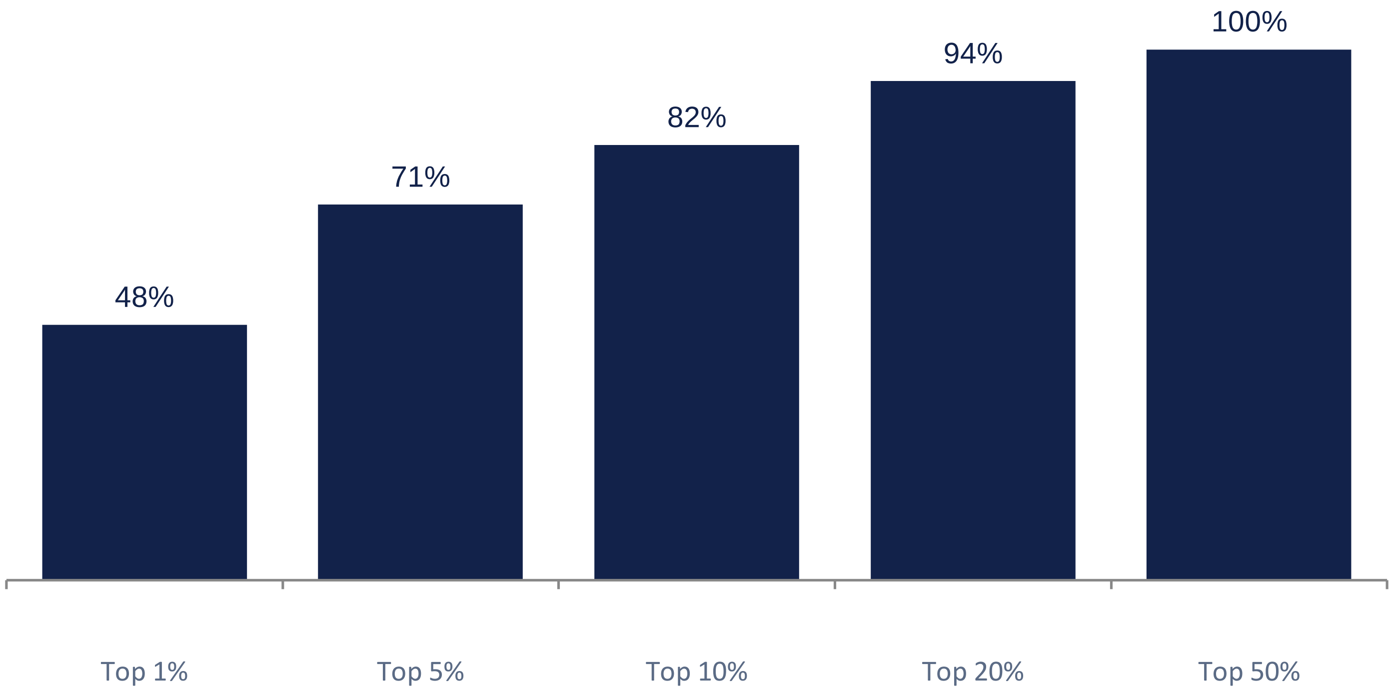
Market structure

A power-law economy, not a broad base of businesses

INSIGHTS 01–03 OF 10

Value is concentrated in a handful of businesses

Cumulative share of total MRR held by top X% of listings



$282 vs $13,472

median vs. mean MRR per month — a 47x gap

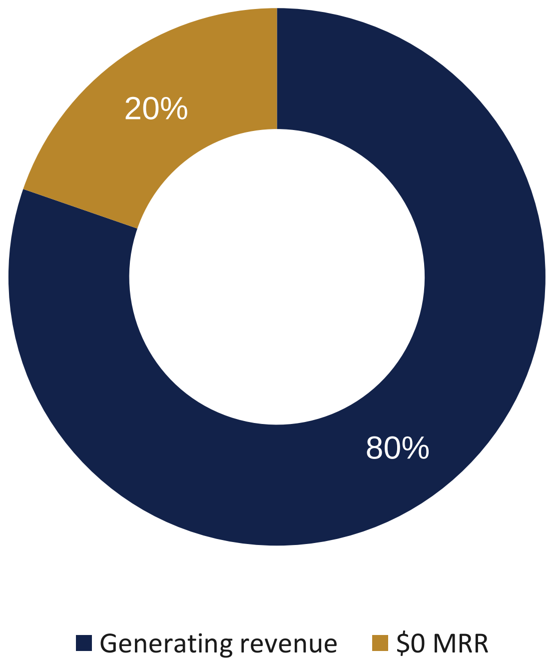
48%

of all MRR sits with just the top 1% of listings (10 businesses)

→ *This tells us the market is narrow at the top. It doesn't yet tell us how many of the other 990 listings are real businesses at all. That's Insight 02.*

Roughly one in five listings generate zero revenue

Share of listings by revenue status



Median listing = $282/mo

roughly $3.4K annualized - early-stage or hobby scale, not a proven business

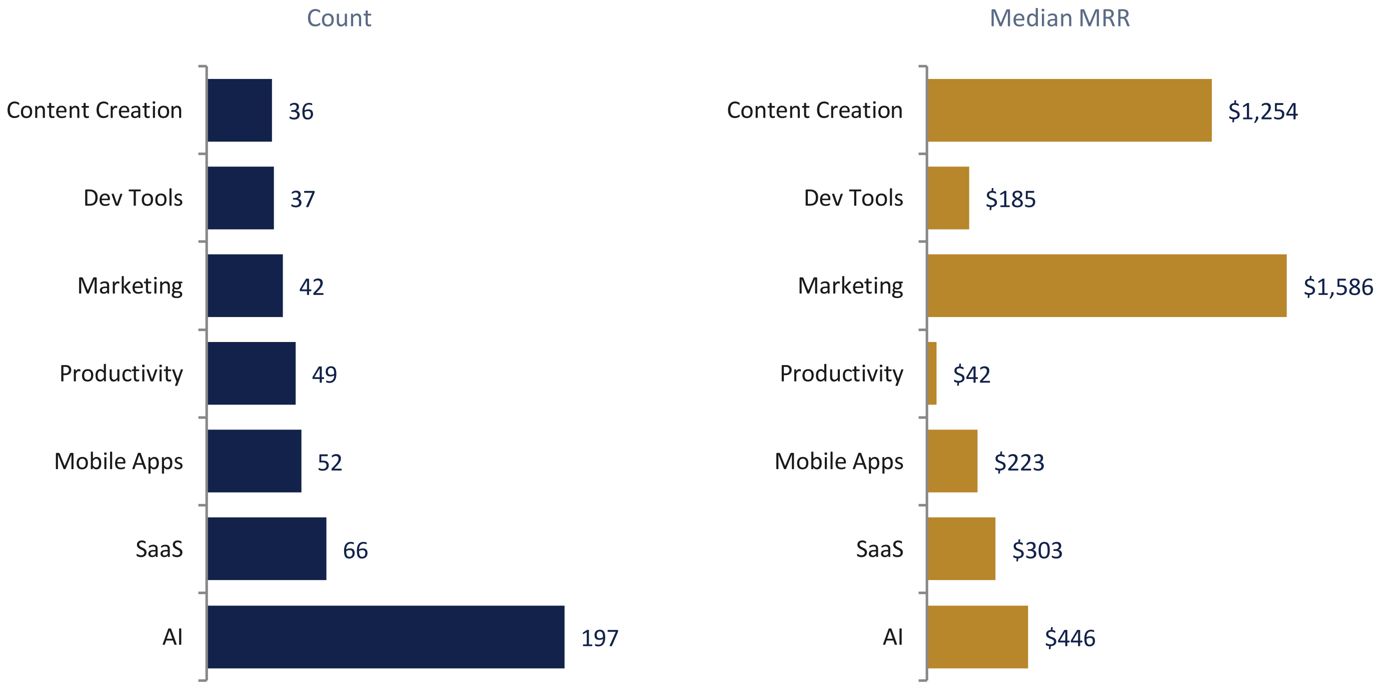
Most “inventory” isn't investable yet

the platform's headline count of 1,000 businesses overstates the real, monetizing pool by roughly 5x

→ *So, the base of “real” businesses is smaller than it looks. Next: even among listings that do earn revenue, category choice doesn't guarantee quality - see AI.*

The most crowded category monetizes the worst

Listings (count) vs. median MRR ($) by category



~3x

AI has roughly 3x the listings of the next-largest category

$446 vs $1,586

AI's median MRR trails Marketing's — volume of entrants ≠ monetization quality

→ *Category name is not a quality filter. Chapter 2 asks the sharper question: what observable traits actually predict a real, monetizing business?*

02

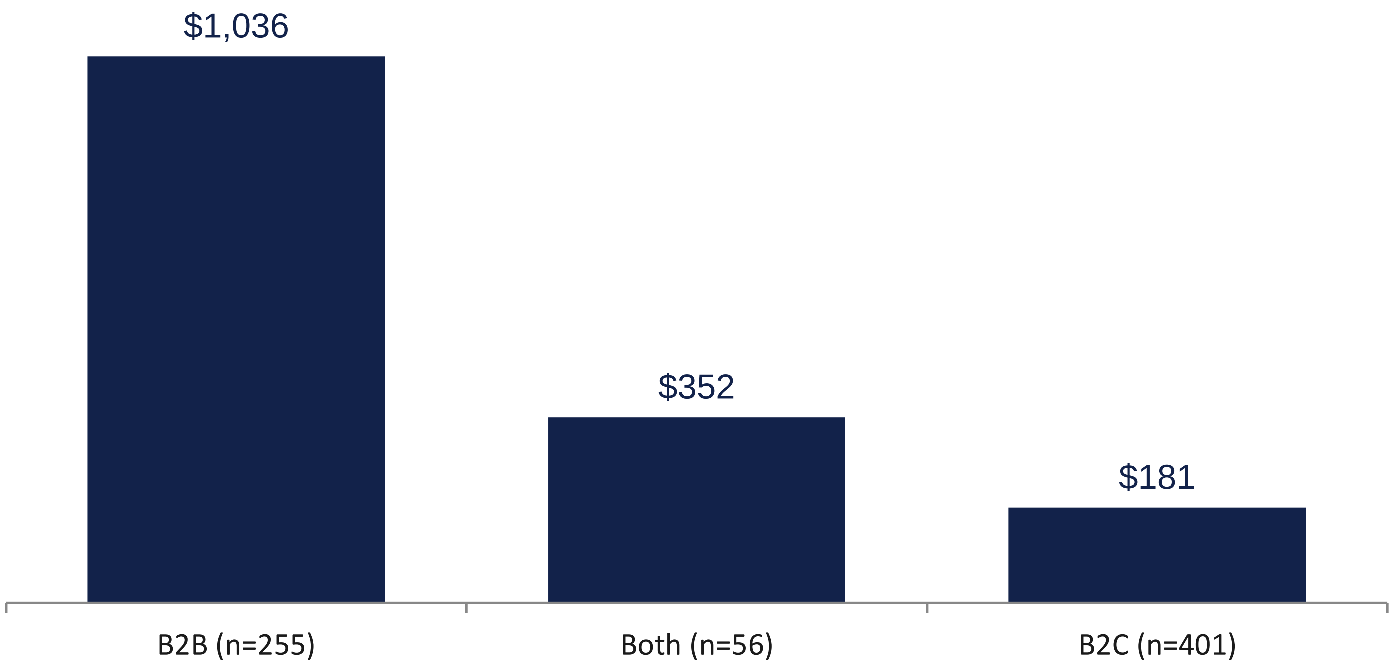
What separates the winners

The signals that reliably predict a real, monetizing business

INSIGHTS 04–07 OF 10

B2B businesses monetize 5.7x better than B2C

Median MRR by audience type ($)



5.7x

B2B revenue premium over B2C, at the median listing

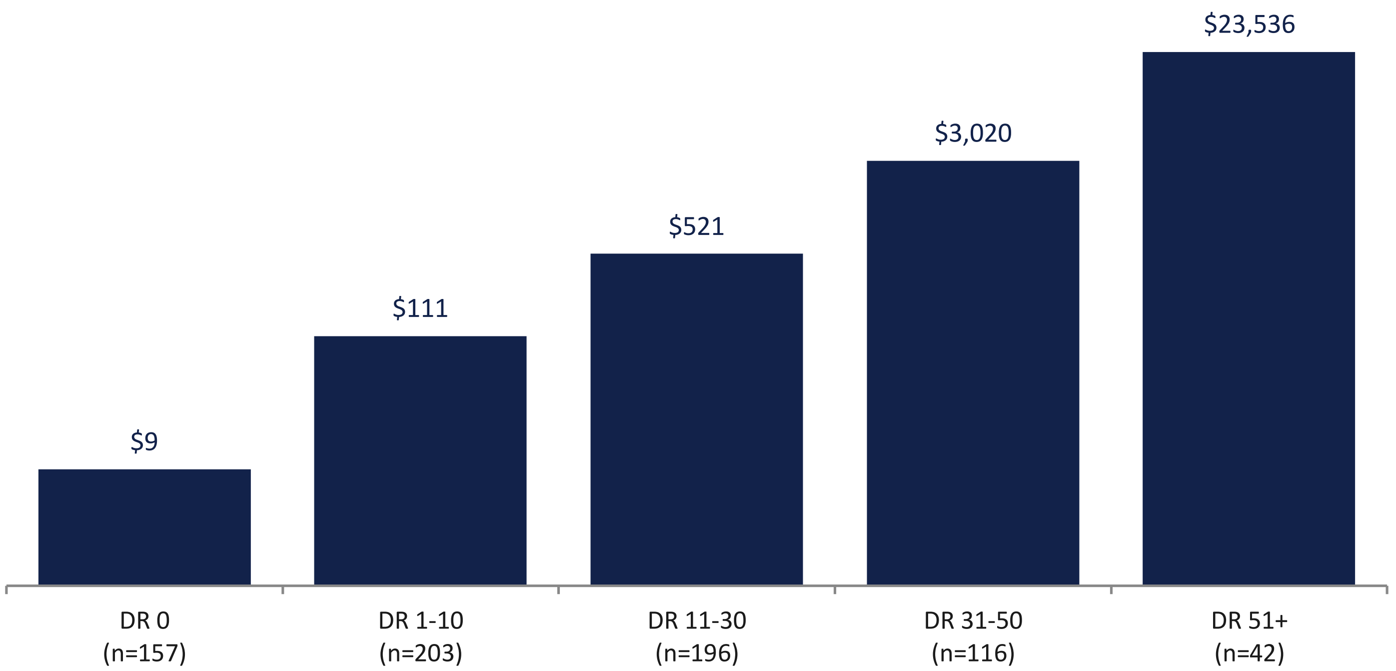
Signal #1 of 4

Audience type is the first of four traits this section identifies as predictive of a real business

→ *Audience type is one filter. But not every metric that looks like quality predicts revenue. Domain authority does; we test it next.*

SEO authority is the strongest predictor of revenue tier

Median MRR by domain rating (DR) bucket ($)



2,500x

spread in median MRR from DR 0 to DR 51+

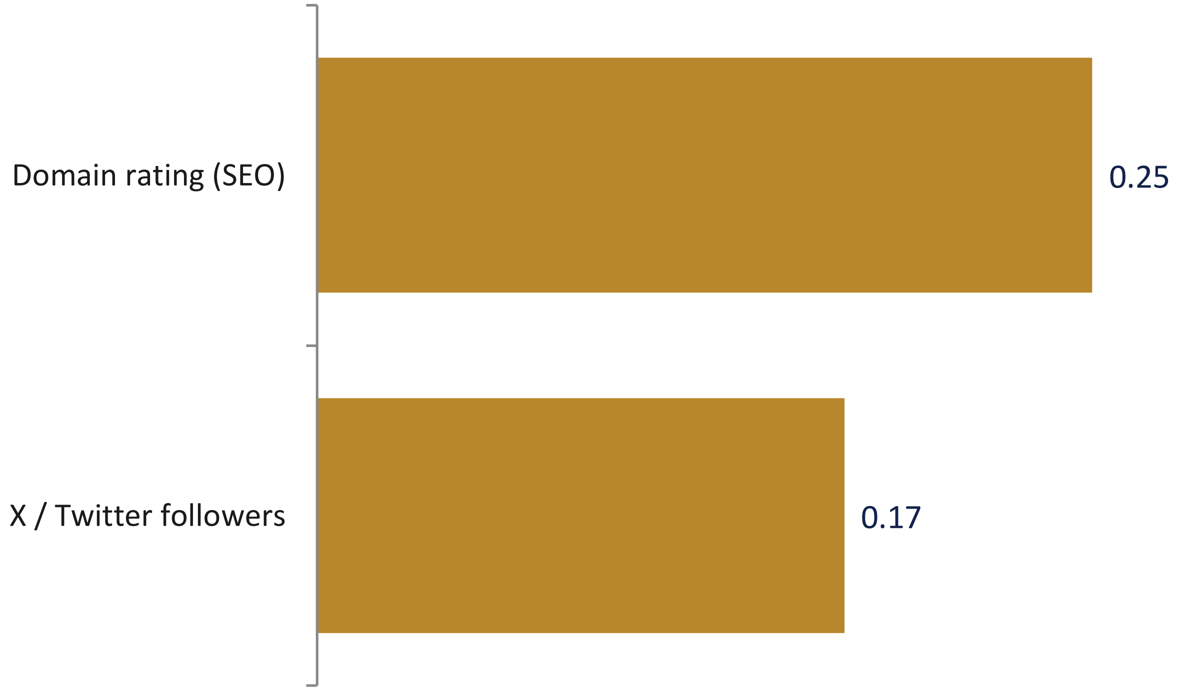
Signal #2 of 4

An owned, compounding SEO asset beats a rented audience — correlation 0.25 vs. 0.17 for followers (next)

→ *Domain authority is a real signal. Now the control case: is social following just as predictive, or is it noise dressed up as traction?*

Follower counts mislead more than they inform

Correlation with revenue, log-log basis



0.17

Correlation between follower count and revenue - the weakest of any signal tested

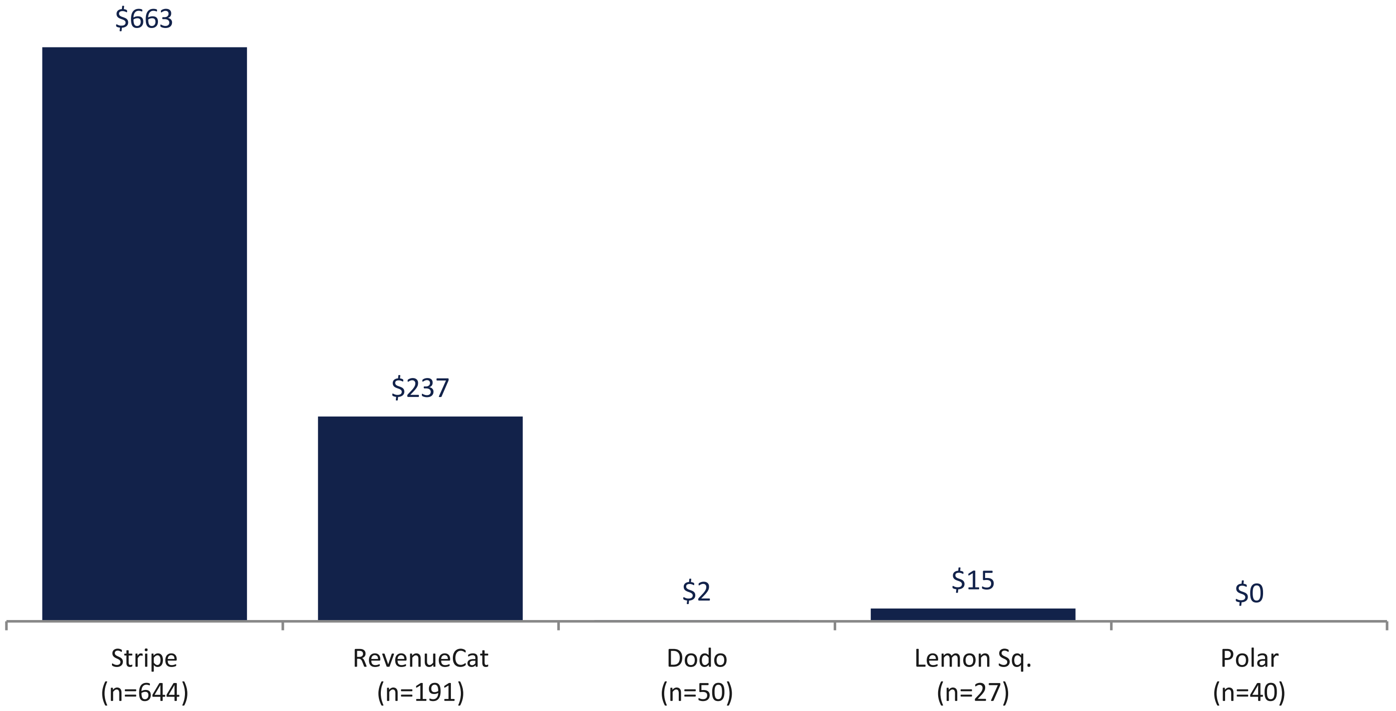
Signal #3 of 4 — a negative one

A large audience does not reliably convert into paying customers here; screen it out, don't screen for it

→ *If audience size is noise, what about the infrastructure a business runs on? Payment stack turns out to be a much better tell.*

Payment stack signals monetization maturity

Median MRR by payment stack ($)



$663 vs $2

Median MRR, Stripe/RevenueCat sellers vs. Dodo Payments sellers

Signal #4 of 4

Subscription-native infrastructure completes the four-signal filter: B2B + domain authority + real payment stack + (not) followers

→ *With the four-signal filter defined, Chapter 3 turns to where and how to apply it starting with geography.*

03

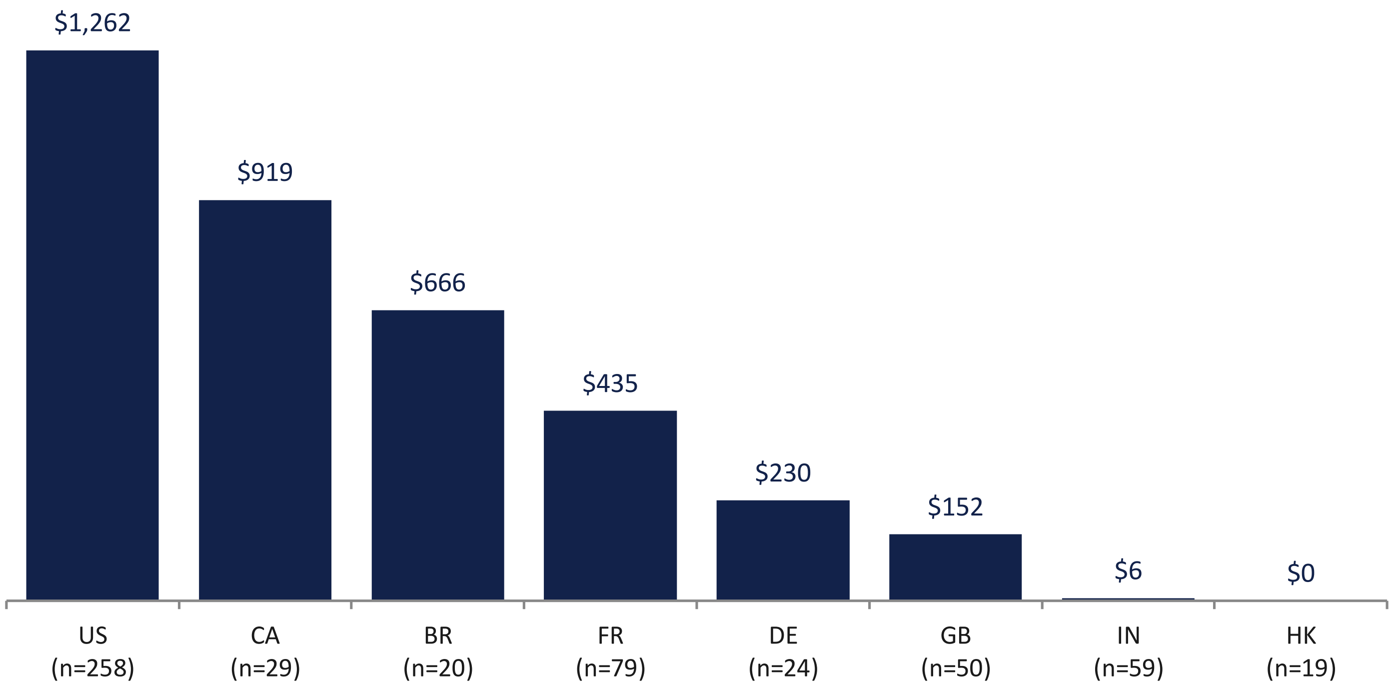
Implications for capital allocation

Where the data says to look and where it says not to

INSIGHTS 08–10 OF 10

Geography is a proxy for pricing power, not just volume

Median MRR by country, top listing markets ($)



26%

of all listings are US-based — and the US is also the highest-monetizing market

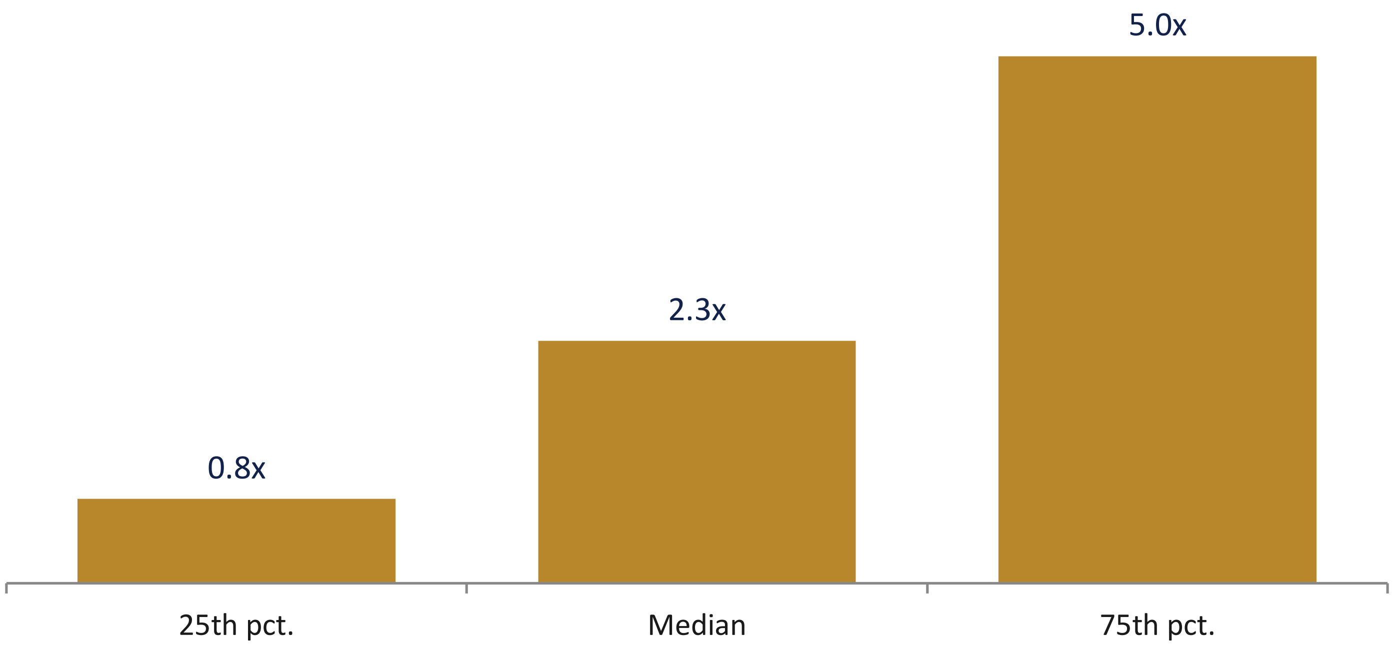
India & Hong Kong

show meaningful listing volume but near-zero median monetization - volume ≠ quality here either

→ *Apply the four-signal filter within a market, not across markets blindly. Next: once you've found a real business, don't trust its price tag yet.*

The “for-sale” market is priced inconsistently

Revenue-multiple distribution across 262 on-sale listings (x)



0x – 327x

observed range of revenue multiples — no single revenue base explains asking price consistently

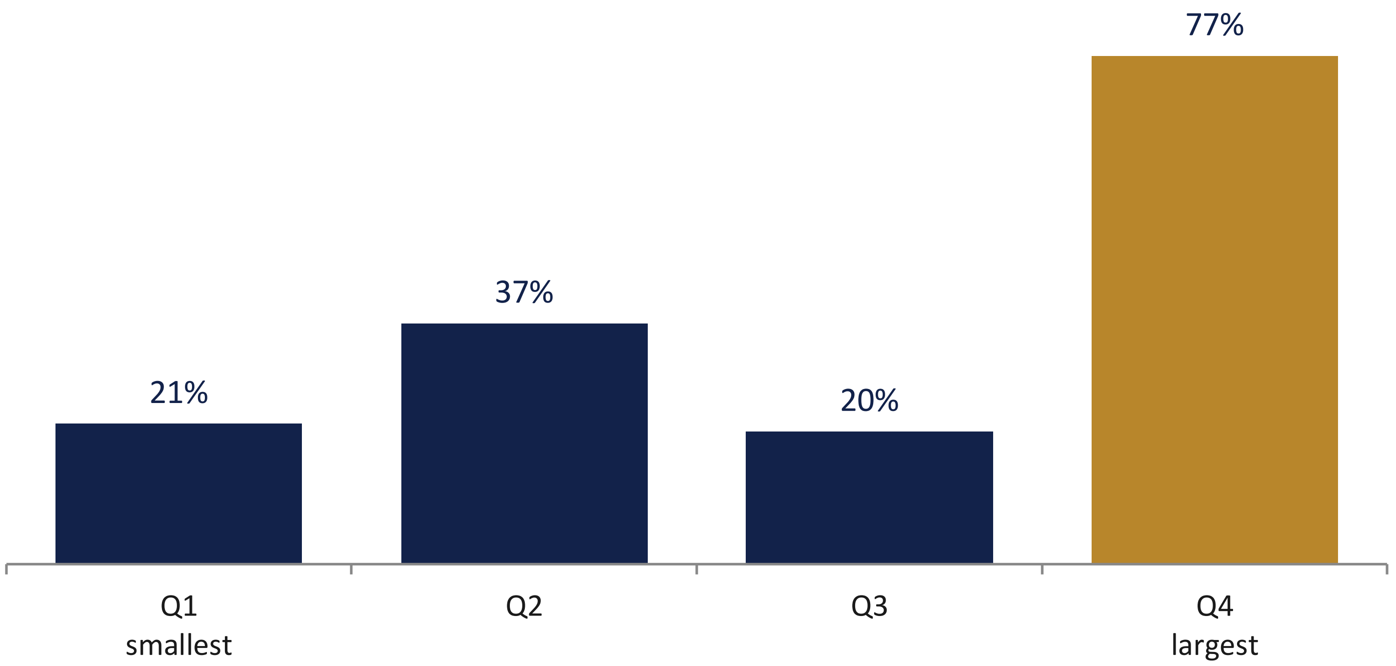
5.6x

higher median MRR for on-sale listings ($1,055) vs. non-listed ($187) sellers do list real traction, just at inconsistent prices

→ *So, the filter finds real businesses, but the price tag still needs independent underwriting. Last data point: the winners you find are pulling further ahead every month.*

The largest businesses are growing the fastest

Average 30-day MRR growth rate by size quartile (%)



3.6x

faster average MRR growth for the largest quartile vs. the smallest

Insight 01, revisited

the power-law concentration from Insight 01 is not static. It is actively reinforcing itself every month

→ *That closes the loop back to where we started the ten insights now converge on one conclusion.*

SYNTHESIS

Ten insights, one storyline

01 Market structure

1. Top 10% hold 82% of MRR

2. 1 in 5 listings earn $0

3. AI is crowded, monetizes worst

02 What separates winners

4. B2B beats B2C 5.7x

5. Domain authority: strongest signal

6. Followers: weakest signal

7. Payment stack signals maturity

03 Capital allocation

8. Geography = pricing power

9. Asking multiples are inconsistent

10. Growth compounds at the top

CONCLUSION: TrustMRR is not a broad, investable ecosystem. It is a small set of real businesses, identifiable by four signals, sitting inside a much larger pool of pre-revenue projects whose asking prices cannot be taken at face value.

BOTTOM LINE

Filter hard before you evaluate a valuation multiple

This is the “so what” of all ten insights: don't index on breadth or vanity metrics. Index on the traits that predict a real business.

1

Screen on the four-signal filter

B2B + domain authority + subscription-native payment stack and treat follower count as noise. (Insights 4–7)

2

Discount self-reported multiples

Asking-price multiples range 0x–327x and don't reconcile against any single revenue base - underwrite independently. (Insight 9)

3

Expect concentration, not breadth

82% of value sits with 10% of listings, and the gap is widening every month - size diligence effort and urgency accordingly. (Insights 1, 10)

APPENDIX

Source & methodology note

Dataset	TrustMRR, 1,000-row export, frozen 30 July 2026. 29 fields per listing spanning revenue, traffic, pricing, and sale status.
Revenue figures	Self-reported by listed businesses via connected payment providers (Stripe, RevenueCat, Paddle, and others); not independently audited.
Missing data	Coverage varies by field. E.g., visitors_30d and category are populated for a minority of listings; medians and correlations use available data only.
Valuation multiples	“Revenue multiple” is a self-reported field on for-sale listings and does not reconcile cleanly to any single disclosed revenue metric.